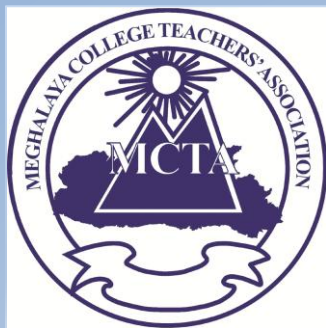




36th Biennial Conference | 2024–2026

A concise account of the Association's work, collective efforts, achievements and continuing commitments in advancing the interests, rights and welfare of college teachers in Meghalaya.

MCTA General Secretary's Report

26th April 2024 to 24th
September 2026

List of MCTA Executive Committee Members 2024-26 (Elected 26th April, 2024 in the 35th Biennial

Sl. No.	Office	Elected
1	President	Mr. Shiv K. Pradhan (St. Anthony's College)
2	Vice President	Dr. Mary Anne Jyrwa (CTE-PGT, Shillong)
3	Vice President	Mrs. Amanda Basaiawmoit (Shillong College)
4	General Secretary	Mrs. L. W. Kharpuri (Union Christian College)
5	Joint Secretary (NEHU Matters)	Dr. Kerlihok L. Buam (Synod College)
6	Joint Secretary (Legal Matters)	Dr. Prashant Sarkhel (St. Edmund's College)
7	Joint Secretary (Academic Matters)	Dr. (Mrs.) Shairi Nongbri (Lady Keane College)
8	Joint Secretary (Sports and Socio-Cultural)	Shri. Snarmon Lato (Shillong College)
9	Joint Secretary (AIFUCTO)	Dr. Daniel Nongbri (Lady Keane College,)
10	Joint Secretary (Technical)	Mr. Farlando Diengdoh (St. Anthony's College)
11	Treasurer	Ms. Camelia Kharsyntiew (Shillong College)
12	Executive Member	Mr. David F. Marbaniang (St. Anthony's College)
13	Executive Member	Mr. Barometer Nongbri (Shillong College)
14	Executive Member	Dr. (Mrs.) A. P. Warjri (Synod College)
15	Executive Member	Dr. Edelbert B. Majaw (Synod College)
16	Executive Member	Dr. Duwaki Rangad (St. Edmund's College)
17	Executive Member	Ms. Sarah Syngkon (Lady Keane College)
18	Executive Member	Dr. Apsaralin Nongsteng (Lady Keane College)
19	Executive Member	Dr. Jimcarbrist P. Marak (Union Christian College)
20	Executive Member	Mr. Shaikupar Kharshiing (Sankardev College)
21	Executive Member	Mrs. Marvel Rose Jyrwa (St. Mary's College)
22	Executive Member	Mr. Ubabunlang Dkhar Tmar (St. Mary's College)
23	Executive Member	Dr. Sanggra A'gitok Sangma (Don Bosco College, Tura)
24	Executive Member	Dr. Lobisor Kurbah (St. Edmund's College)
25	Executive Member	Mr. Witting Mawsor (Nongstoin College)

Conference, Shillong College)

NEHU Academic Council Members [NEHU CDC Notification No. AC:5/ Conf/89 (Vol. V)-743 on 27th May 2024 for 3 years]

Sl. No.	Name
1	Dr. Jimcarbrist. P. Marak
2	Mr. Nangsan Kupa Swer
3	Mr. David F. Marbaniang
4	Mr. Shiv. K. Pradhan
5	Ms. Rilana Lamar
6	Dr. Prashant Sarkhel

Ex-Officio Members

Sl No.	Office	
1.	Outgoing General Secretary	Dr. Daniel Nongbri (Lady Keane College)

MEGHALAYA COLLEGE TEACHERS' ASSOCIATION

GENERAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

For the 36th Biennial Conference

Period: 26th April 2024 – 24th September 2026

1. INTRODUCTION

The 36th Biennial Conference of the Meghalaya College Teachers' Association (MCTA) provides an opportunity not only to place before the General Body an account of the activities undertaken during the period under report, but also to reflect upon the larger questions that have confronted the Association and its members during this tenure.

The period from 26 April 2024 to 24 September 2026 has been marked by significant developments in higher education in Meghalaya, continuing challenges relating to the service conditions and welfare of college teachers, and, most importantly, the continuing struggle of the Association to safeguard the legitimate interests and long-term financial security of its members.

The work of the Association during this period has therefore extended beyond routine representations and correspondence. It has involved sustained engagement with the Government and its departments, legal interventions, collection and examination of data from member colleges, engagement with matters concerning the North-Eastern Hill University (NEHU), participation in the wider teachers' movement, and efforts to strengthen solidarity among college teachers across the State.

At the same time, it would not be appropriate for this report to present the tenure merely as a list of achievements. An association such as the MCTA must also honestly acknowledge the matters which remain unresolved. Some issues have moved forward; some have required prolonged intervention; and several continue to demand determined collective action from the Association.

The present report accordingly attempts to place before the General Body the issues taken up, the position adopted by the Association, the action undertaken, developments during the period, and the work that remains unfinished.

2. CPF AND PENSION MATTERS

Of all the matters that occupied the attention of the Association during the period under report, the question of the **Central Provident Fund and pension arrangements of employees of deficit colleges** has been among the most consequential.

The Association had initiated legal proceedings with the objective of securing a proper and legally sustainable provident fund arrangement for employees covered by the relevant statutory framework. The matter, which had its origins in concerns raised by the Association regarding the existing arrangements, subsequently resulted in directions requiring the Government to address the issue within the framework of the applicable law.

During the present tenure, however, the matter entered a new and more complicated phase with the emergence of the **Pension Scheme, 2026** and the subsequent constitution of a new Board of Trustees.

At the **Emergent Extended Executive Committee meeting held on 9 April 2026**, the Executive Committee was apprised of developments concerning the CPF case, including the objections filed in connection with the Pension Scheme, 2026 and the contempt proceedings. The Association expressed concerns regarding the conformity of the new scheme with the statutory framework and the earlier directions of the Court. The meeting also recognised the need for greater organisational preparedness and collective action.

The Association subsequently convened an **Emergent General Body Meeting on 14 April 2026**, with representatives of allied associations, including the KJDSTA, MCNTEA and GHDSTEA, invited to participate. The meeting was convened specifically to explain the Pension Scheme, 2026 to members, discuss its implications and determine the way forward.

The General Body was apprised of the history of the CPF matter, including the Association's intervention since 2018 and the legal steps undertaken to secure a scheme capable of providing adequate financial security to employees. The statutory background of the CPF framework and the developments following the Government's decision to formulate a new scheme were also discussed.

The emergence of the Pension Scheme, 2026 raised several concerns within the Association, including its relationship with the statutory framework, the treatment of employees irrespective of length of service, the contribution structure, provisions relating to withdrawal and annuitisation, and the manner in which the scheme was sought to be implemented.

The Association also raised concerns regarding the **constitution and functioning of the Board of Trustees**, particularly its composition and conformity with the relevant bye-laws and statutory provisions. These concerns were pursued through the appropriate legal channels.

On **27 April 2026**, the Government issued a notification constituting the Board of Trustees under the **Meghalaya Provident Fund Act, 1969** and the **Meghalaya Non-Government School and College Employees Centralised Provident Fund Scheme, 2026**. The notification assigned the Principals of the deficit colleges and the Manager, SBI Laitumkhrah, responsibility for implementing and administering the CPF scheme and managing the fund and its investments through the annuity system.

The Executive Committee has consistently maintained that the CPF matter cannot be reduced to the interests of individual petitioners. At its meeting on **19 June 2026**, it was resolved that the Association should communicate to its legal counsel that the matter was an **institutional and collective concern of the MCTA and its members**.

The Association's position throughout has been that any arrangement affecting the retirement security of employees must be **legally sound, transparent, properly administered and capable of delivering the security for which it was intended**.

The CPF and pension matter therefore remains one of the **principal unfinished tasks before the Association**, requiring continued organisational attention, legal preparedness and collective engagement.

3. LEGAL MATTERS AND PENDING FINANCIAL BENEFITS

Alongside the CPF and pension matter, the Association continued to pursue other legal and financial issues affecting the service conditions and financial entitlements of teachers of deficit grant-in-aid colleges. These matters remain important areas of unfinished work.

3.1 CPF AND PENSION CASE- CURRENT STATUS

The CPF and Pension matter, dealt with substantively in **Section 2**, also remains under legal consideration. Following the **Meghalaya High Court judgment dated 10 September 2026**, the Association has been left at liberty to challenge the Meghalaya Non-Government Schools and Colleges Employees Centralised Provident Fund Scheme, 2026 through appropriate proceedings.

The Association has been advised to pursue a **review before the Division Bench**, particularly in relation to the factual and procedural issues arising from the judgment. The CPF/Pension matter therefore remains an important unfinished legal matter requiring continued attention.

3.2 ALLOWANCE CASE

The MCTA has continued to pursue the restoration and payment of **House Rent Allowance, Medical Allowance, Hill Compensatory Allowance and Winter Allowance** to teachers of deficit grant-in-aid colleges.

The **Supreme Court, in its judgment dated 23 August 2022**, upheld the substantive entitlement of teachers to these four allowances and held that the implementation of UGC Pay Scales did not, by itself, justify their withdrawal. The Court, however, limited entitlement to allowances from **1 January 2018** and did not direct the refund of earlier recoveries.

Following the judgment, the State paid the allowances up to **September 2022**, after which payment was stopped. The MCTA pursued compliance through subsequent proceedings, including contempt proceedings before the Meghalaya High Court.

The Association subsequently approached the Supreme Court in **SLP(C) Nos. 32289–32290 of 2025**. The matter remains pending before the Supreme Court, with substantive hearing/final adjudication awaited.

The restoration and regular payment of these allowances therefore remain an outstanding financial and legal matter for the Association.

3.3 DEARNESS ALLOWANCE ARREARS

The Association has pursued the pending **Dearness Allowance revisions from 53% to 55%, 55% to 58%, and 58% to 60%**, together with the consequential arrears.

The DHTE, through its order **No. CE/GR/ACCTS/DA/32/2022-2023/69 dated 23 April 2026**, directed the colleges to submit the necessary bills. The concerned colleges complied with the direction and submitted the required bills.

However, the **three DA revisions and the corresponding arrears remain unpaid**. The Association continues to pursue the matter with the concerned authorities and will need to maintain follow-up until the pending revisions and arrears are implemented.

4. DHTE, GOVERNMENT MATTERS AND SERVICE CONDITIONS

A major area of the Association's work during the tenure has been sustained engagement with the Government and the DHTE on matters affecting the service conditions, financial security and academic environment of college teachers.

On **23 March 2025**, an MCTA CEC delegation met the then Minister of Law, **Smti. Ampareen Lyngdoh**, and took up the **CPF case, Allowance Case, pending DA arrears, NEP/FYUP issues, People's Colleges, the limited participation afforded to teachers' representatives in the Chief Minister's Pre-Budget consultation, and the need for academic auditing to identify grassroots issues faced by educational institutions.**

On the same day, the MCTA met the **Commissioner & Secretary, Education Department, Shri Vijay Kumar Mantri, IAS**, regarding the **2023 Draft CPF Scheme, allowances and pending DA arrears.** The Commissioner informed the delegation that the CPF matter had been referred to the **Finance Department and the Advocate General.** During the discussion, he indicated that he was not aware of the **Meghalaya Provident Fund Act, 1969**, which formed the statutory basis for the 2023 Draft CPF Scheme for employees appointed before 1 April 2010. He also remarked that continued Government support to Deficit Grant-in-Aid Colleges could be discontinued, stating that Grant-in-Aid depended upon the **"benevolence of the Government."**

The MCTA has consistently maintained that adequate faculty strength, proper service conditions and financial security are essential to sustaining the quality of higher education.

4.1 FACULTY VACANCIES AND TEACHING STRENGTH

During the tenure, the Association undertook a data collection exercise from member colleges to establish a clearer picture of sanctioned teaching posts, vacancies, teachers continuing on State Scale despite opting for UGC Scale, and teachers awaiting upgradation to UGC Scale.

This exercise enabled the Association to place a more evidence-based memorandum before the Government rather than relying only upon general representations.

As per the data received from the colleges that responded to the Association's Google Form, circulated on 30th June 2026, there were 488 sanctioned teaching posts, of which 34 were reported as vacant. The data also indicated that a significant number of sanctioned posts had fallen vacant due to retirement, with St. Edmund's College alone reporting more than 20 retirements. However, these vacancies have not been reflected as vacant sanctioned posts, indicating that the corresponding sanctioned posts may have effectively been discontinued. The Association has raised concerns regarding the discontinuation of sanctioned posts without their transfer or replacement, which has further affected the teaching strength of colleges.

The memorandum further drew attention to the increasing academic responsibilities arising from the revised academic framework associated with FYUGP and NEHU. The fourth year, in particular, involves research, internships and advanced disciplinary engagement, thereby placing additional demands upon existing faculty strength.

The Association accordingly requested time-bound filling of sanctioned vacancies, review and augmentation of sanctioned teaching strength in view of the expanded academic requirements, creation of additional posts where necessary, and early settlement of pending pay and service-related matters.

Despite raising these concerns with the Hon'ble Education Minister, the Association has not received a positive response or a definite commitment regarding the filling, transfer or restoration of the affected sanctioned posts. The issue of faculty strength therefore remains an important matter requiring continued attention by the Association.

4.2 RECRUITMENT AND PLACEMENTS

4.2.1. Recruitment

The issue of faculty vacancies naturally led to the question of recruitment of qualified teachers. The Association has consistently maintained that sanctioned teaching posts should be filled within a reasonable and transparent timeframe, particularly in view of the increasing academic responsibilities arising from the implementation of FYUGP. The Association has also raised concerns regarding instances where UGC-sanctioned posts have been removed or replaced by State Scale posts, thereby affecting the availability of posts for recruitment.

The MCTA will continue to pursue the filling of sanctioned vacancies and the protection of existing sanctioned teaching posts with the concerned authorities.

4.2.2. Placement and Career Advancement Scheme (CAS)

At the Executive Committee meeting held on 19th June 2026, the Association reviewed the status of placement cases and teachers awaiting movement from State Scale to UGC Scale. The Joint Secretary of Legal and DHTE Matters reported **67 placement cases** at that stage. The Association has pursued these cases with the concerned authorities, and some progress has been made in facilitating the placement of members whose cases had remained pending.

The Association will continue to pursue pending placement and CAS cases with the Education Department and seek a clear and time-bound mechanism for their settlement.

4.2.3. Gratuity / Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity (DCRG)

The MCTA took up the long-pending issue of gratuity and gratuity differences of retired teachers during the tenure. On 12 July 2025, the Association called upon all units to furnish details of retired teachers who had either not received their gratuity or were awaiting the gratuity difference, so that the matter could be taken up with the appropriate authorities.

The information received revealed a substantial number of pending DCRG cases across several colleges, involving both non-payment of the full gratuity and pending differences. The Association pursued **73 such pending cases** with the concerned authorities. While DCRG cases are required to be resolved within **45 days from the date of retirement**, these cases had remained pending despite the necessary administrative processes having been initiated.

The MCTA is pleased to report that the **73 cases pursued by the Association have since been settled**. The Association will continue to monitor such cases and take up any future delays with the concerned authorities to ensure that eligible retired teachers receive their full gratuity and DCRG benefits within the stipulated timeframe.

5. HIGHER EDUCATION, NEHU AND ACADEMIC MATTERS

The period under report witnessed significant changes in the higher education sector, particularly with the implementation of FYUGP and the continuing evolution of the academic framework under NEHU. These

changes have brought new academic responsibilities and challenges for college teachers, making sustained engagement with NEHU and the Government essential.

The MCTA has consistently maintained that academic reforms must be accompanied by adequate faculty strength and institutional support. In its memorandum to the Hon'ble Education Minister dated 7 July 2026, the Association highlighted that the fourth year of the revised framework involves research, internships and advanced disciplinary engagement, thereby necessitating a corresponding review of faculty strength.

5.1. MCTA'S ENGAGEMENT WITH THE MEGHALAYA EDUCATION GRANT (MEG)

In May 2025, the Education Department issued the **Discussion Paper on the Consolidation of Multiple Grant-in-Aid Schemes for Educational Institutions in Meghalaya**, proposing a unified Meghalaya Education Grant (MEG). Recognising the implications of the proposal for colleges and college teachers, the MCTA examined the Discussion Paper and sought the views of its constituent units.

Following its consultations, the Association submitted its **formal response to the Commissioner & Secretary, Education Department, on 27 May 2025**, registering its rejection of the proposal in its then-present form and raising concerns regarding its adequacy in addressing the specific needs of higher education.

The MCTA subsequently participated in a **consultative meeting with senior officials of the Education Department on 8 July 2025** to discuss the proposed MEG. During the meeting, the Association **submitted a second written response, reiterating its rejection/non-endorsement of the MEG proposal in its present form.**

During the discussion, the MCTA raised concerns regarding the application of the school-level **Performance Grading Index (PGI) to Higher Education Institutions**, the need for a sector-specific and evidence-based approach to higher education policy, the protection of UGC-aligned service conditions, and the inadequate number of sanctioned Professor posts in the State.

The Association also emphasised the need to recognise the distinct academic and regulatory framework governing higher education and called for a more comprehensive assessment of the diverse categories of Higher Education Institutions in the State. The Government officials clarified that the Discussion Paper remained **preliminary in nature** and that a second draft would be shared for wider consultation before final implementation.

This engagement demonstrated the MCTA's role in **policy intervention and consultation**, ensuring that the concerns of college teachers were formally placed before the Government at both the initial and subsequent stages of consideration of the MEG proposal.

5.2. ACADEMIC COUNCIL, NEHU MATTERS

Following the notification of 27 May 2024, six members representing the Association were elected to the **NEHU Academic Council** for a three-year term. The members are: (i) Dr. Jim P. Marak; (ii) Mr. Nangsan Kupa Swer; (iii) Dr. David F. Marbaniang; (iv) Mr. Shiv Kumar Pradhan; (v) Ms. Rilana Lamar; and (vi) Dr. Prashanta Sarkhel.

Since assuming office, the representatives have participated in regular and emergent meetings of the Academic Council and have consistently raised matters concerning the implementation of **NEP and**

FYUP in affiliated colleges, particularly issues affecting college students and the academic and infrastructural requirements of the fourth year.

A significant development was the **34th Emergent Academic Council Meeting held on 9 June 2026**, where Resolution No. EAC:34:2026:5:8(iv) was passed requiring colleges offering the fourth year of the undergraduate programme to **appoint two additional teachers in accordance with UGC norms**, over and above the staffing prescribed for the three-year undergraduate programme. The resolution also called for adequate **library resources, books, laboratory facilities and other infrastructure** necessary for the effective implementation of FYUP.

This intervention is particularly significant in the context of the Association's continuing efforts to ensure that the expansion of academic programmes under FYUP is accompanied by corresponding faculty strength and institutional infrastructure.

6. AIFUCTO AND THE WIDER TEACHERS' MOVEMENT

The MCTA continued to maintain its connection with the **All India Federation of University and College Teachers' Organisations (AIFUCTO)** during the tenure. Notifications and newsletters received from AIFUCTO were circulated among the constituent units, keeping members informed of developments concerning the wider teachers' movement. The Association also participated in the **AIFUCTO poster campaign held on 7 August 2026**.

The incoming Executive Committee should continue these efforts and **strengthen the MCTA's ties and active engagement with AIFUCTO**.

7. WELFARE OF MEMBERS

The welfare of members remains a fundamental responsibility of the Association. During the tenure, the MCTA extended **financial assistance of ₹25,000 to Shri Wympher Langtang on 10 April 2025** as part of its commitment to the welfare and support of its members.

The Association should continue to strengthen its welfare measures and extend support to members in times of need.

8. COLLECTIVE ACTION AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

The MCTA continued to engage in collective action and solidarity with other teachers' organisations on issues affecting public education and the service conditions of teachers.

On **21 August 2025**, the MCTA expressed its solidarity with the **All Primary School Teachers' Association (APSTA)** in its protest against the Meghalaya Education Grant (MEG). Through a formal letter addressed to the President of APSTA, the Association conveyed its support and emphasised the importance of safeguarding and strengthening public education. Members of the MCTA also participated in the APSTA rally, demonstrating the Association's solidarity through direct participation in the collective action.

In **2026**, the MCTA, together with the KJDSTA and other teachers' associations, participated in protests, poster campaigns and joint engagements with the press concerning the Pension Scheme 2026. These

collective engagements reflected the associations' objections to the Scheme and their concerns regarding its implementation while the matter remained sub judice.

On **4 May 2026**, a statewide Poster Campaign was carried out by teaching and non-teaching staff of schools and colleges across Meghalaya. Through placards and issue-based posters, participants reiterated their demands concerning the implementation of the NPS for employees appointed on or after 1 April 2010, the implementation of the mutually agreed **Draft Pension Fund Scheme, 2023** for employees appointed prior to 1 April 2010, and withdrawal of the **Meghalaya Non-Government Schools and Colleges Employees Centralised Provident Fund Scheme, 2026**.

On **6 May 2026**, the MCTA, KJDSTA and MCNTEA participated in the Government meeting on the proposed Scheme. After placing their objections on record, the three associations were permitted by the Chair, Commissioner & Secretary Shri Vijay Kumar Mantri, to leave the meeting. The GHDSTEA had not been invited to the meeting. The MCTA and KJDSTA subsequently submitted a joint written objection to the Minutes, particularly concerning resolutions recorded after their departure and the need for the Minutes to accurately reflect their objections.

At the **14 May 2026** meeting, the stakeholder associations in the CPF matter—the **MCTA, KJDSTA, GHDSTEA and MCNTEA**—were present, along with **AMPSTA**. The stakeholder associations continued to place their concerns regarding the proposed Scheme on record. The **Pension Scheme 2026** was subsequently passed in the absence of the stakeholder associations.

These collective engagements reflected the Association's efforts to work in solidarity with other teachers' organisations and to place the concerns of college teachers before the Government through institutional, legal, public and democratic means.

9. R. R. THOMAS MEMORIAL INTER-COLLEGE DEBATE COMPETITION

9.1. 13TH R.R. THOMAS MEMORIAL INTER-COLLEGE DEBATE COMPETITION 2025

The 13th R. R. Thomas Memorial Inter-College Debate Competition was organised by the MCTA on 11 April 2025 at the Synod College Auditorium, Shillong. Colleges including Synod College, Lady Keane College, Shillong College, St. Edmund's College, Union Christian College, St. Mary's College and St. Anthony's College participated.

The motion was "The Rise of Social Media Influencers is Good for Society," with students presenting arguments for and against the motion. The competition provided an important platform for developing students' critical thinking, oratory and public-speaking skills.

Nyonyok Talom of St. Edmund's College was adjudged Best Speaker, followed by Deboleena Bhattacharjee of St. Mary's College as Second-Best Speaker and Lariphylla Kharpuli of Synod College as Third-Best Speaker.

The successful conduct of the competition reaffirmed the value of such initiatives in fostering healthy academic competition, analytical ability and public-speaking skills among students. The MCTA should continue to preserve and strengthen such academic initiatives as part of its broader engagement with the student and academic community.

9.2. 14TH R.R. THOMAS MEMORIAL INTER-COLLEGE DEBATE COMPETITION 2026

The 14th R. R. Thomas Memorial Inter-College Debate Competition was organised by Shillong Commerce College, in collaboration with the Meghalaya College Teachers' Association (MCTA), on 22 September 2026 at the Main Auditorium of Shillong Commerce College, as part of the College's Diamond Jubilee celebrations. Eighteen student debaters from nine colleges across the State participated in the competition.

The motion for the debate was "The Four-Year Undergraduate Programme benefits students more than it burdens them." The debate was presided over by Prof. S. M. Sungoh, Retired Professor, Department of Education, NEHU and former Pro Vice-Chancellor, NEHU, with Dr. Mary Anne Jyrwa, Ms. Ibankyntiew Mawrie and Mr. Eboton Kharkongor serving as judges.

Mr. Odawanlangki Sutnga of Kiang Nangbah Government College, Jowai, won the First Prize and Best Speaker award. Ms. Sneha Das of St. Edmund's College secured the Second Prize, while Mr. Aryan Chetia of St. Anthony's College secured the Third Prize. Mr. Arian Donald Rani of Synod College was adjudged Humorous Speaker, while Ms. Sneha Das and Mr. Addiel J. Surong of St. Edmund's College were awarded Best Team.

The competition concluded with the distribution of prizes and trophies, recognising the participants' articulation, critical thinking and rhetorical skills. The continued organisation of the R. R. Thomas Memorial Debate Competition reflects the MCTA's sustained commitment to providing students with opportunities for intellectual engagement, healthy academic competition and the development of public-speaking skills.

10. PENDING LAND ISSUE FOR THE MCTA OFFICE

The issue of securing land for the **MCTA office** also remained unresolved during the tenure. In response to the Association's request for allotment of a plot, the Government communicated that it was **unable to allot a plot for the MCTA**. It is pertinent to note that the communication was addressed **not to the Secretary of the previous Executive Committee, but to Dr. B. Buam, who by then was not the President of the MCTA**. The matter remains pending and may require further engagement with the Government by the incoming Executive Committee. The way forward may include seeking the relevant communication and status of the land request through a written representation or RTI, and pursuing the matter with the concerned authorities.

11. OVERALL ASSESSMENT, UNRESOLVED ISSUES AND THE WAY FORWARD

As the present tenure draws to a close, the MCTA's work may be assessed in terms of its response to the legal, financial, academic and organisational concerns of college teachers.

The tenure saw sustained engagement with the Government, DHTE and NEHU; legal intervention on retirement security and financial entitlements; data-driven representations on faculty strength, recruitment and placement; participation in higher education policy discussions and the wider teachers' movement; and continued welfare, solidarity and academic initiatives, including the R. R. Thomas Memorial Inter-College Debate Competition.

Several important matters, however, remain unresolved and will require the continued attention of the incoming Executive Committee. These include:

- **The CPF/Pension matter**, including legal and administrative issues surrounding the Pension Scheme 2026, remains unresolved. **A review petition is to be filed following the High Court judgment of 10 September 2026 and, if required, the matter will be pursued before the Supreme Court.**
- **The Allowance Case**, which remains pending before the Supreme Court and requires continued pursuit until its final adjudication.
- **The pending Dearness Allowance revisions and arrears**, including the revisions from 53% to 55%, 55% to 58%, and 58% to 60%.
- **Faculty vacancies and teaching strength**, including the filling of sanctioned vacancies, restoration or transfer of sanctioned posts that have effectively ceased to exist, and augmentation of teaching strength in response to the requirements of FYUGP.
- **Recruitment, placement and CAS**, particularly the filling of sanctioned UGC posts and the settlement of pending cases of teachers awaiting movement from State Scale to UGC Scale.
- **The academic and infrastructural requirements arising from FYUGP**, including the provision of additional teachers, library resources, books, laboratories and other facilities required for the fourth year of undergraduate education.
- **Continued engagement with NEHU and the Government** on matters affecting the academic environment, service conditions and institutional requirements of affiliated colleges.
- **Continued engagement with AIFUCTO and other teachers' organisations**, so that the MCTA remains connected with wider developments affecting higher education and the teaching profession.
- **MCTA Office Land:** The Government has communicated its inability to allot a plot of land for the MCTA office. The matter remains unresolved and requires continued engagement with the Government by the incoming Executive Committee.

The experience of the tenure demonstrates that complex issues affecting teachers require sustained engagement over time. Representation, documentation and legal intervention remain essential, but their effectiveness depends upon accurate information, institutional follow-up and the active participation of the membership.

The way forward must therefore combine **evidence-based representation, sustained institutional dialogue, legal preparedness and collective action**. The incoming Executive Committee will need to maintain continuity in the matters already pursued while identifying new challenges arising from changes in higher education, service conditions and Government policy.

Above all, the Association must continue to function as a collective body, ensuring that the concerns of individual members are addressed within a broader institutional framework and that decisions affecting the teaching community are approached with transparency, consultation and due process.

12. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Before concluding, I wish to place on record my sincere appreciation to the President of the MCTA, the Vice-Presidents, Joint Secretaries, Treasurer, Executive Committee members and the office bearers of all constituent units for their cooperation during the period under report.

The work of a General Secretary can never be the work of one individual. Every representation, meeting,

legal intervention, data-collection exercise, conference preparation and organisational activity depends upon the cooperation of colleagues across the Association.

I am particularly grateful to the Joint Secretaries for the responsibilities they have undertaken in their respective areas and for the assistance extended to the General Secretary throughout the tenure.

I also acknowledge the patience and participation of our members. An association derives its authority not from the office held by its office bearers, but from the trust and collective participation of its membership.

I thank the Synod College Unit for agreeing to host this 36th Biennial Conference, and the Principal for her kind accommodation of having us in this august college, along with all the incumbent officers of the MCTA Synod College Unit and members.

13. CONCLUSION

The period from **April 2024 to September 2026** has been demanding for the MCTA, with continued engagement on retirement security, financial entitlements, service conditions, faculty strength, recruitment and academic reforms.

While several matters remain unresolved—including the **CPF/Pension matter, Allowance Case, pending financial dues, faculty vacancies and placement-related issues**—the tenure also saw concrete interventions, including the settlement of **73 pending DCRG cases**, strengthened faculty data and representations, engagement with NEHU on FYUGP, policy consultations and participation in the wider teachers' movement.

The responsibility for carrying these matters forward now rests with the incoming Executive Committee. The continuity of this work will depend upon institutional memory, sustained follow-up and the active participation of members.

The MCTA remains a collective institution representing the professional interests, dignity and long-term security of college teachers in Meghalaya. It is my hope that the **36th Biennial Conference** will mark not merely a transition of office bearers, but a continuation of collective representation, informed engagement and solidarity.

I thank all members for their cooperation and support throughout the tenure.

Thank you.

Long Live MCTA